

东南康州中文学校之窗

Community News



- ◆ On January 20th, students in Ms. Helen Xiong's Colloquial Mandarin Chinese classes held a gathering in the Chinese restaurant Taste of China in Clinton, CT to experience Chinese cuisine first hand. Mr. Shaowei Du, an English teacher from Shandong, China, was invited to the gathering.
- ◆ On February 16th, SECCCS (Southeastern Connecticut Chinese Culture Society) successfully held a celebration of Chinese New Year and a Cooking Contest called "Taste of East Lyme".
- ◆ "East in the West" art show was opened recently at the La Grua Center in Stonington, CT. The art works of SCCS teachers, Mr. Christopher Zhang, Ms. Yujuan Zhai, and several of their students were selected to be on display during the Art Show. On February 15th, several SCCS students and teachers were invited to attend and performed for an opening ceremony. Their performances won praise from the attendees.
- ◆ On January 24th, several SCCS teachers and students were invited to perform for a Chinese New Year celebration at the Zhang's Restaurant in Old Saybrook, CT. The celebration was held by "Connecticut Coastal Adoptive Families".
- ◆ Mingfei Duan, an East Lyme Middle School 7th grader, recently won the first place in the Mathcounts Chapter Competition and the second in the Mathcounts State Competition. He will represent the state of CT in the national Mathcounts in Washington DC later this year. Mingfei is attending the SCCS Mathcounts class. Congratulations!
(Ms. Yinyu Tu)



1/20/2013 CMC Class Gathering



From left to right: Rachel Tan, Mr. Gionet; Mingfei Duan; Davon Chen and Akash Mishra

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The New Year Celebration And Cooking Contest

It was February 16, the 7th day of the first month of the lunar year, and the weather calmed down after the snow storm Nemo. The Southeastern Connecticut Chinese Culture Society celebrated the Chinese New Year, the Year of the Snake, and held a cooking contest, named "The Taste of East Lyme", at East Lyme Middle School.

With hope as well as uneasiness, SECCCS staff came to prepare for the celebration around 11 o'clock in the morning. This celebration was scheduled to be held a week ago with over 70 families signed up to come to the event. Then an unexpected snow storm forced the celebration to be rescheduled. Would this storm wash away people's enthusiasm? After all, 7 days had been passed since the New Year's Day, and the spring break was right around the corner How many families would come to this event? Our worries were unnecessary. The auditorium became full before noon with happy laughter and cheerful voices!

The celebration began with the Cooking Contest. This contest was the first of its kind in East Lyme, and may be even the first time in southeastern Connecticut. Thirty nine courses of feasts showcased different cooking styles and demonstrated variety and uniqueness of diet culture in different places in China including Uygur Lamb Pilaf Hand, Central Plain Beef Tail, Curry Chicken from southeast Asia, etc. After judges finished their grading, the long expected "new year eve dinner" officially started. Although there were no jade dishes and fancy food, the sense of color, smell and taste let people eat heartily, but with some regret. Why? Because there was no wine to pair with the delicious food!

The result of the cooking contest has made it known to all that although East Lyme is small and at a faraway corner, this place can be described as one of "Crouching Tigers and Hidden Dragons" (meaning there are a lot of undiscovered talents). On top of the winners of this contest whom people have known, there are some rising stars who made people look up them with new eyes. Jing Chen, who used to be an East Lyme resident, came from Boston this time and wrapped up two golds and one silver, became a deserved master of cooking in this contest. Yinyu Tu and Zeya Liu, local residents, didn't want to play the second fiddle, and also bagged a few medals. However, the most commendable winners are two senior chefs: "Daddy Lu" and "Daddy Jiang". "Daddy Lu's" Huai Yang Lion Head (pork meat ball in brown sauce) and "Daddy Jiang's" Sichuan Burning Plane not only won the first places, the taste of their foods impressed the diners as well. The latter praised their excellent cooking skills and also appreciated their hard work!

After the "dinner", people sat together watching the magic and dancing, while cracking melon seeds, eating peanuts, ..., as if we all were enjoying the village theatrical performance in a Chinese New Year in old days in China. All families enjoyed the happiness of the reunion, especially, the grandparents enjoyed the pleasure of heavenly agreement by mouthing malt sugars and playing with their grandchildren. If the hostess had asked me at that time what happiness is, I would have said that happiness is the feeling I got when I saw people smiling and enjoying this event into which we had put a lot of time and effort.

And I am happy because the delicious food was just leaving people's mouths, but the milk of human kindness had grown in our heart!

(Mr. Shengquan Duan)



Magic Show of New Year Celebration



Snap Shot of New Year Celebration

A Pervasively Fragrant Bouquet

Newly arrived in US, I immediately enrolled myself in an English literacy class. While at the class cramming up the English, I encountered a fellow Chinese. Being congenial with each other, I invited her to visit my home. In my backyard, she looked over the little pond, the quiet forest... paused, and then said to me with a smile: "There seems to be something missing." I was puzzled by her comment. Not long after, she brought me a tender bamboo, and told me to plant it.

I gladly planted the bamboo near a big rock in my backyard and took good care of it day in and day out. The season was changing, as the leaves were falling under the autumn wind. However, the bamboo didn't seem to grow much. The leaves were still hanging on the branches, but looked withered. The leaves seemed to be expecting, or complaining? Later, an old gentleman told me that there didn't seem to be enough sunshine, so the bamboo might not make it through the winter. Sadness went through my mind...

Winter was gone and spring came. One day I happened to be in my backyard. What I saw stunned me: There came out an array of bamboo shoots around the bamboo! A few days later, a small green bamboo grove appeared. I looked around the environment and found that the bamboo survived and flourished by absorbing the little Sun beams filtered through branches of a big tree near the rock. While amazed by her vitality, I was equally amazed by how little she asks in order to sustain and grow such a vibrant life.

This makes me think about our overseas Chinese. We came to this land from all walks of life and a variety of places. Many feel lonely here. No matter how difficult the situation seems to be, we shall act like the little tender bamboo - persevering with however little the environment may give, and growing and contributing with our own unique ability in this land of opportunity.

(Ms. Chu Ling)



Mr. Dehua
Chen

"East in the West" Art Show



Ms. Yujuan Zhai



Dancing: Jasmine — Caitlyn Liu, Hanna Hong

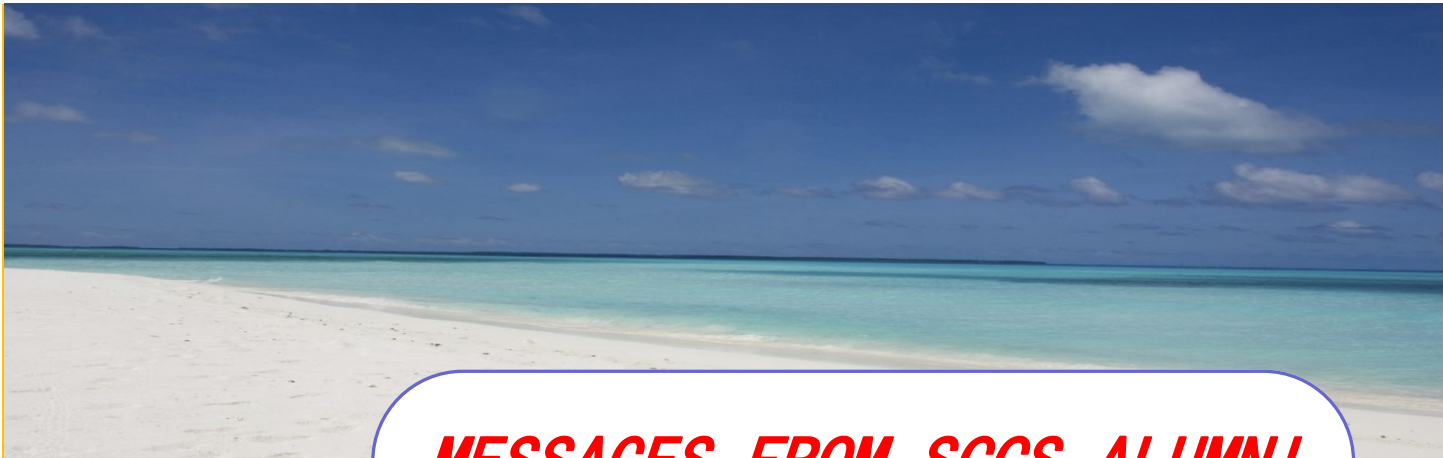
2013 Talent Show Announcement

The SCCS 2013 talent show will be held in ELHS auditorium on May 19th from 10 am to 1 pm. The talent show has become an important platform for our students to demonstrate their understanding of Chinese language and culture. It also provides an excellent opportunity for them to gain stage performance and leadership experience. We encourage all our students to participate.

The talent show will be organized by a committee consisting of SCCS administration team members, and representatives of teachers and parents.

Please register by filling an [Online Registration Form](#). The deadline is April 21st, 2013.

By SCCS Talent Show Organizing Committee



MESSAGES FROM SCCS ALUMNI

Nanjing, China: **Yinsheng Zhang** was the coach of Martial Arts and Tai Chi classes at SCCS. He is now in China working for Zheng Da Tian Qin Pharmaceutical company located in Xu Zhuang Development District near the Sun Yat-Sen Mausoleum and the Mausoleum of the Ming Emperor. His research focuses on new drug design and synthesis, innovation as well as drug metabolism. Yinsheng spends his after-work time live chatting with his wife and children via QQ and playing Tai Chi, Qi Gong and Tai Chi Ball. He misses the peaceful way of the life in southeastern Connecticut and friends at SCCS

(Ms. Fang Fang)



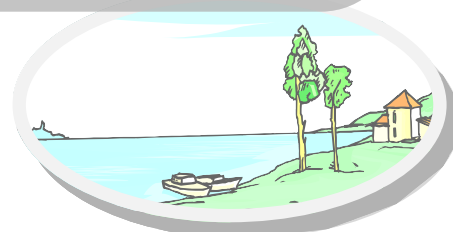
Yingsheng & Fang at New Year Celebration

Storrs, CT: **Andrew Bi** was a teacher's assistant in math, a student teacher in math, art, and basketball at SCCS during his high school years. Currently, he is a sophomore in CPiM (Combined Program in Medicine) at University of Connecticut.

SCCS provided an excellent learning environment and cultural enrichment to Andrew's growth. The opportunities he had at SCCS played a significant role in developing his responsibilities and leadership skills. *(Ms. Jing Lin)*



Andrew Bi



2013 Snap Shots of New Year Celebration



Cooking Contest Winner
Daddy Lu



New Year Celebration 1



New Year Celebration 2



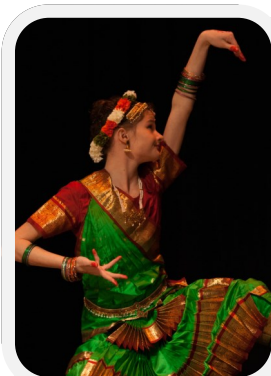
Corner of Dessert Table



New Year Celebration 3



New Year Celebration 4



Indian Dance—Anika Kavalla,
Anabel Makover (left)



Cooking Contest Winner
Daddy Jiang



Cooking Contest Winner
Ms. Jing Chen

New Year Celebration of Coastal Adoptive Families



Dance: Arianna Xie, Daphnie Lu



Lion Dance: Ryan Xu, Paul Chang



Magic Show of New
Year Celebration